GAMSA · Gender-Affirming Medicines South Australia

Pharmacy visit checklist

For family, friends and carers going to the pharmacy with or for someone on hormone therapy · gamsa.au/allies

Before you go

- [ ] The prescription (paper, or the electronic token on their phone)
- [ ] Their Medicare card, and concession or Health Care Card if they have one
- [ ] The name of the medicine, the brand they use, and the strength (a photo of the box is enough)
- [ ] Their usual pharmacy's name and phone number, in case you go somewhere else
- [ ] If the person is not coming, their permission to collect it, and the name they use

At the counter

- [ ] Ask for the person's name, as they use it, on the label
- [ ] Ask whether the price is the PBS price, and whether the Safety Net has been recorded. In 2026 a PBS script costs up to $25.00, or $7.70 with a concession card, plus any brand premium
- [ ] If the person is Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander, ask the pharmacist to check they are registered for Closing the Gap. It lowers the PBS price at any pharmacy
- [ ] Ask whether a 60-day prescription is possible for this medicine
- [ ] If a different brand is offered, ask whether it is the same medicine and strength (brand substitution is usually fine; a different medicine needs the prescriber)
- [ ] Ask how many repeats are left, and whether the pharmacy can hold them on file

> **Do not** adjust, hold or top up doses, and do not swap medicines on your own. If something seems wrong, ring the prescriber or pharmacist. In an emergency call 000.

If it is out of stock

- [ ] Ask when the next delivery is expected, and whether they can order it in
- [ ] Check gamsa.au/supply: it shows which products are affected and what other pharmacies have reported in stock
- [ ] Ask about another brand or strength of the same medicine; the pharmacist can often substitute during a declared shortage (for estradiol patches, this is allowed until 28 February 2027)
- [ ] If the pharmacist suggests a different medicine, ring the prescriber before accepting
- [ ] Try one or two other pharmacies by phone before driving around

Afterwards

- [ ] Note when the next supply or the next injection is due
- [ ] Keep the receipt; it counts towards the PBS Safety Net. Once a household's PBS spending reaches $1,748.20 in a year ($277.20 with a concession card; 2026 figures), scripts cost less for the rest of that year
- [ ] Put the medicine away as the label says (some patches and gels have storage rules)

Useful numbers

QLife, peer support for LGBTIQ+ people and those around them, 3pm to 9pm every day	**1800 184 527**
Translating and Interpreting Service	**131 450**
1800MEDICARE, to talk to a registered nurse at any hour	**1800 633 422**

Based on gamsa.au: Working with your pharmacy, Costs and the PBS, Supply & shortages, and the Easy Read guide "Helping someone with their medicine". PBS prices and Safety Net thresholds can change on 1 January each year. Not medical advice. PBS information (not GAMSA's own): the co-payment and Safety Net amounts. Source: Pharmaceutical Benefits Scheme (PBS) Schedule, reproduced with permission of the Australian Government Department of Health, Disability and Ageing. Extracted from www.pbs.gov.au on 5 November 2026.

Prepared by Theodore South, BPharm (Hons), registered pharmacist · gamsa.au
Questions or corrections: gamsaenquiries@gmail.com

Version 1.5 · 6 November 2026
Current version: gamsa.au/allies